



**Darla Moore
School of Business**
UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH CAROLINA



Welcome to the 2026 HR@Moore survey conducted in conjunction with The CHRO Association (formerly HR Policy Association).

This year, the Center for Executive Succession at the Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina and The CHRO Association have partnered to combine our CHRO surveys. The survey has been developed by Patrick Wright working in conjunction with the following CHROs, as well as the

CHRO Association team:

2026 HR@Moore CHRO Survey Advisory Board

Christy Pambianchi - <i>Current Chair</i> Catepillar	Anita Graham Labcorp	Christian Meisner GE Aerospace
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The CHRO Association

Tim Bartl Chief Executive Officer	Ani Huang President, Policy and Practice
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Instructions

The purpose of this survey is to explore the CHRO role and understand how CHROs address their organization's challenges. Our hope is to provide CHROs with data regarding key leverage points which will increase their effectiveness, particularly regarding interfaces with the Board of Directors and other members of the Executive Leadership Team.

This year we focus on board and executive succession, leadership behaviors, and governance processes.

All answers are confidential and are seen only by the researchers administering the survey.

- No data will be released that is not aggregated across all of the respondents.
- Quotes from open-ended questions will never be attributed to individuals.
- Any potentially identifying information will be stripped before use.

Please answer the questions to the best of your ability. However, to save time, please feel free to skip any questions where you do not feel you have any particular insights or are not comfortable answering. On the open-ended questions, should you choose to answer, we request that you provide enough detail to ensure that we know what you mean. For example, instead of "identifying talent" you might be more specific and say "identifying the right executive level talent", or "making sure we have enough bench strength among our executive team".

If you have any questions, please contact: Patrick Wright at Patrick.wright@moore.sc.edu.

Demographics

1. What is your gender?

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Prefer not to answer
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

2. What is your race/ethnicity?

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino/Latina
- ☐ Asian (East Asian, Southeast Asian, South Asian)
- ☐ Native American, Alaska Native, or Indigenous
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

- ☐ Middle Eastern or North African
- ☐ Mixed Race or Multiracial
- ☐ Prefer Not to Answer
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

3. How many full-time employees does your company have?

- ☐ up to 4,999
- ☐ 5,000 to 24,999
- ☐ 25,000 to 99,999
- ☐ 100,000 to 999,999
- ☐ 1 million or more

4. Did your headcount increase, decrease, or stay the same over the past year?

- ☐ Decrease
- ☐ Stay the Same
- ☐ Increase

5. How long have you been a CHRO (total, not just in your company)?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1 to 3 years
- ☐ 4 to 6 years
- ☐ 7 - 10 years
- ☐ 10 years or more

6. How long has the CFO been a CFO (total, not just in your company)?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1 to 3 years
- ☐ 4 to 6 years
- ☐ 7-10 years
- ☐ 10 years or more

7. How long has the General Counsel been a GC (total, not just in your

company)?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1 to 3 years
- ☐ 4 to 6 years
- ☐ 7-10 years
- ☐ 10 years or more

8. How long have you been in your current role?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1 to 3 years
- ☐ 4 to 6 years
- ☐ 7-10 years
- ☐ 10 years or more

9. What is the budget for your HR department/function?

- ☐ Up to \$9.9 million
- ☐ \$10 to \$49.9 million

- ☐ \$50 to \$199.9 million
- ☐ \$200 million or more

10. Over the next three years, do you expect your HR budget to increase, decrease or stay the same?

- ☐ Increase
- ☐ Decrease
- ☐ Stay the same
- ☐ Don't know/not sure

CHRO Roles

11 Of the eight components of the Model of a World-Class CHRO listed below, please indicate which **TWO components are most critical to the success of most CHROs** (in general, not just yourself) and **which TWO components are**

most lacking among a new CHRO stepping into the role for the first time.

Please select no more than TWO components in each category.

	Most Critical to CHRO Success (Select up to 2)	Most Lacking in NEW CHROs (Select up to 2)
Functional Business Leader: (Create a future-focused, financially disciplined team to run the HR function)	☐	☐
Business Acumen: (Understanding how the firm makes money and developing and aligning all HR processes based on bottom-line impact...or understanding how the firm makes money and considering the financial impact in the design and development all HR processes, initiatives, and activities)	☐	☐
Business Strategy: (Participating in and influencing the development of the business strategy)	☐	☐
Board's Leader of Human Capital: (CEO succession, executive compensation, responding to external trends)	☐	☐
Creator of Talent Strategy: (Staffing critical roles, designing talent management processes, directing strategic workforce planning)	☐	☐

Most Critical to CHRO Success
(Select up to 2)

Most Lacking in NEW CHROs
(Select up to 2)

Enterprise Change Leader: (Challenging the status quo, planning/ implementing enterprise change, managing stakeholders and advocating for employees)

☐☐

Driver of Culture and Purpose: (Linking purpose to culture, measuring/ communicating the culture, holding leaders accountable for culture promise)

☐☐

Trusted Advisor and Coach: (Advising/ coaching the CEO, maximizing ELT effectiveness, coach/ develop key enterprise talent)

☐☐

12. Select the five issues of most immediate concern to you as the lead human resources officer of a major corporation. *(Please select only five)*

- ☐ AI and digitization of the workplace (including data privacy and cybersecurity)
- ☐ Backlash against ESG
- ☐ Diversity, equity and inclusion
- ☐ Employee engagement
- ☐ Employee relations (independent contractors, workforce activism)
- ☐ Employee well-being

- ☐ Executive compensation and corporate governance
- ☐ Executive development, including critical role succession
- ☐ Globalization of the company's workforce
- ☐ Health care strategies
- ☐ HR functional development
- ☐ Increased union activity
- ☐ Mergers, acquisitions, and divestitures
- ☐ Organizational change
- ☐ Pay equity and pay transparency
- ☐ Productivity and cost cutting
- ☐ Supervisor and manager capability
- ☐ Talent acquisition and retention
- ☐ Workplace culture/cultural transformation
- ☐ Executive team effectiveness
- ☐ Business/financial performance
- ☐ Board governance/refreshment
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

CHRO PAY

13. We have been exploring the pay of the CHRO relative to the CFO and the General Counsel. Using the most recent proxy data, what is the CHRO's and GC's pay as a percentage of the CFO's pay?

Base Pay

Total Direct Compensation

General Counsel

CHRO

Healthcare Costs

14. Which strategies is your organization using to manage rising healthcare costs, particularly related to specialty pharmaceuticals? (Select all that apply)

☐ Step therapy or prior authorization protocols for specialty drugs

- ☐ Negotiating directly with pharmaceutical manufacturers or using alternative sourcing
- ☐ Adopting value-based care arrangements with providers
- ☐ Offering high-deductible health plans (HDHPs) with HSAs
- ☐ Using specialty pharmacy management programs
- ☐ Implementing utilization management and clinical review processes
- ☐ Increasing employee cost-sharing (copays, coinsurance, deductibles)
- ☐ Offering narrow or tiered pharmacy networks
- ☐ Providing biosimilar education and incentives for switching
- ☐ Implementing point solution vendors for specific conditions
- ☐ Moving to self-funding or level-funding arrangements
- ☐ Have not implemented specific strategies for specialty pharmaceutical costs
- ☐ Other (please specify)

15. Does your organization's health plan currently cover GLP-1 medications (such as Wegovy, Zepbound, Saxenda) for weight loss/obesity management (not diabetes treatment)?

- ☐ Yes, we cover GLP-1s for weight loss with specific eligibility criteria
- ☐ Yes, we cover GLP-1s for weight loss with minimal restrictions
- ☐ No, we only cover GLP-1s for diabetes management

- ☐ No, we do not cover GLP-Is for weight loss, but we are actively considering it
- ☐ No, we do not cover GLP-Is for weight loss and have no plans to add coverage
- ☐ Other (please specify)

C-Suite Succession

16. How did the following executives and you (CHRO) come into the role?

		Internal	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
CEO		☐	☐	☐
CFO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐
CHRO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐
General Counsel	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐

CTO/CIO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐
CMO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐

17. As far as the board is concerned, what do you think the majority believe about the timing of CEO succession?

- ☐ A CEO succession event **will definitely** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **will likely** happen in the next 2-5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen in the next 2-5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **probably won't** happen until after 5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **definitely won't** happen until after 5 years

18. To what degree would you agree with the following statements regarding CEO succession?

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
The CEO is regularly engaged and active with regard to CEO succession planning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO actively makes CEO succession planning a priority	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes hiring an internal candidate is an indicator of his/her success in developing talent	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO objectively evaluates and develops talent.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes it is important for him or her to be actively involved in succession planning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes the success or failure of the next CEO is an important part of his or her legacy	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

19. Thinking about where you currently are in regards to CEO succession planning, how effective has the Board been at conducting or overseeing the following activities?

[illegible]

Developing appropriate plans for transition of incoming executives

☐☐☐☐☐☐

Developing appropriate plans for transitioning outgoing executives

☐☐☐☐☐☐

Notifying candidates of their status in the executive succession pool

☐☐☐☐☐☐

Recognizing and supporting the role the CHRO plays

☐☐☐☐☐☐

The following questions focus on the prevalence and origins of C-suite succession failures (if you feel this information is too sensitive, feel free to leave blank)

20. In your experience, over the last 5 years, of the **INTERNAL** promotions into C-suite roles, what **PERCENTAGE** of them resulted in failure (i.e., had to be removed or should have been removed within a year or two)?



21. Based on your experiences with senior **INTERNAL** C-suite hires that failed, please rate how frequently each was a cause of that failure:

Never Rarely Sometimes Always

The nature of how the job was structured made it difficult for one to succeed

☐☐☐☐

The person turned out to not have the necessary skills to succeed in the job.

☐☐☐☐

The scale of the job was much bigger than the individual's previous job, and the individuals could not scale up adequately.

☐☐☐☐

The person's skill mix did not fit well with that of the rest of the executive leadership team

☐☐☐☐

	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Always
The individuals' personality (ego, selfishness, narcissism, etc.) did not fit well with the executive leadership team	☐	☐	☐	☐
The individual was unable to develop the necessary relationships to succeed in the role	☐	☐	☐	☐
The leader was too slow to act and deliver on goals	☐	☐	☐	☐
Inability to adopt an enterprise perspective	☐	☐	☐	☐
Inability to succeed in the organization's culture	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other (please specify) 	☐	☐	☐	☐

22. When considering total direct costs (recruitment, signing bonus, salary, bonus, LTIP, severance, etc. associated with the failed executive), what is the average cost of an **INTERNAL** succession failure?

☐ < \$2 million

- ☐ \$2 million – \$5 million
- ☐ \$5 million – \$10 million
- ☐ \$10 million – \$20 million
- ☐ \$20 million – \$30 million
- ☐ > \$30 million

23. In your experience, over the last 5 years, of the **EXTERNAL** promotions into C-suite roles, what **PERCENTAGE** of them resulted in failure (i.e., had to be removed or should have been removed within a year or two)?



24. Based on your experiences with senior **EXTERNAL** C-suite hires that failed, please rate how frequently each was a cause of that failure:

Never

Rarely

Sometimes

Always

The nature of how the job was structured made it difficult for one to succeed

☐☐☐☐

The person turned out to not have the necessary skills to succeed in the job.

☐☐☐☐

The scale of the job was much bigger than the individual's previous job, and the individuals could not scale up adequately.

☐☐☐☐

The person's skill mix did not fit well with that of the rest of the executive leadership team

☐☐☐☐

The individuals' personality (ego, selfishness, narcissism, etc.) did not fit well with the executive leadership team

☐☐☐☐

The individual was unable to develop the necessary relationships to succeed in the role

☐☐☐☐

The leader was too slow to act and deliver on goals

☐☐☐☐

Inability to adopt an enterprise perspective

☐☐☐☐

Never

Rarely

Sometimes

Always

Inability to succeed in the
organization's culture

☐☐☐☐

Other (please specify)

☐☐☐☐

25. When considering total direct costs (recruitment, signing bonus, salary, bonus, LTIP, severance, etc. associated with the failed executive), what is the average cost of an **EXTERNAL** succession failure?

- ☐ < \$2 million
- ☐ \$2 million – \$5 million
- ☐ \$5 million – \$10 million
- ☐ \$10 million – \$20 million
- ☐ \$20 million – \$30 million
- ☐ > \$30 million

Board Succession

26. Internally, among management, who holds primary responsibility for managing the board of directors' succession?

- ☐ CEO
- ☐ GC
- ☐ CHRO
- ☐ No one
- ☐ Other (please specify)

27. What entity on the board holds primary responsibility for managing board succession processes?

- ☐ Independent chair / Lead director
- ☐ Executive chair
- ☐ Nominating/governance chair
- ☐ Nominating/governance committee

- ☐ Compensation/Organization/Talent chair
- ☐ Compensation/Organization/Talent committee
- ☐ Other (please specify)

28. To what extent does your board do each of the following with regard to board succession?

[illegible]

[illegible]

29. Who is involved in performing the following activities related to board succession? *(Please select all that apply)*

[illegible]

	IndChair/ LeadDir	Nom/Gov Chair	Nom/Gov Members	Comp/ Org Chair	Comp/ Org Members	CEO	CHRO	GC	Other
Evaluating current board composition and capabilities / conduct a skills gap analysis	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Developing role profiles for potential directors	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Recruiting potential directors	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Onboarding new directors	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Offboarding outgoing directors	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tracking and mapping potential vacancies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Considering Director compensation to attract new members	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

30. Who interviews potential new directors? *(Please select all that apply)*

- ☐ Lead director/Independent board chair
- ☐ CEO

- ☐ Nominating / gov chair
- ☐ Nominating / gov committee members
- ☐ Other board members
- ☐ GC
- ☐ CFO
- ☐ CHRO
- ☐ Other

31. What has your board done well with regard to director succession?

32. What are the biggest challenges your board faces when it comes to director succession?

33. When onboarding a new director, which of the following do you typically use prior to and in the first few months of their tenure? *(Please select all that apply)*

- ☐ Site visits
- ☐ Lead director/Board chair one on one meetings
- ☐ Meetings with other directors
- ☐ Meetings with CEO
- ☐ Meetings with CFO
- ☐ Meetings with other ELT members
- ☐ Specific board onboarding training
- ☐ External consultants/partner training/onboarding programs
- ☐ Internal company training/onboarding programs

Artificial Intelligence in HR

34. How are you measuring productivity gains from AI?

- ☐ We track adoption rates and user satisfaction surveys

- ☐ We measure time-to-completion for specific tasks before and after AI implementation (or through conducting experiments before implementation)
- ☐ We have established productivity metrics tied to business outcomes (revenue per employee, cycle times, etc.) and track AI's contribution
- ☐ We're using a combination of quantitative metrics and qualitative assessments
- ☐ We haven't established clear productivity measurements yet
- ☐ Other (please specify)

35. What governance model have you established for employees creating custom AI agents ?

- ☐ Centralized approval required for any AI tool outside approved platforms
- ☐ Decentralized experimentation with post-hoc auditing and risk assessment
- ☐ Tiered system: sandbox environments for experimentation, approval process for production deployment
- ☐ Department-level governance with central guidelines and periodic reviews
- ☐ We haven't formalized this yet
- ☐ Other (please specify)

36. How are you redesigning performance management and career pathways for roles being fundamentally reshaped by AI?

- ☐ We're maintaining existing frameworks and adding AI skills as competencies
- ☐ We're piloting new performance metrics such as those focused on judgment, collaboration, and strategic thinking rather than task completion
- ☐ We've redesigned job architectures for AI-adjacent roles but not broadly across the organization
- ☐ We're moving toward skills-based progression models that emphasize adaptability and continuous learning
- ☐ This is on our roadmap but not yet implemented
- ☐ Other (please specify)

37. What employee segments are showing the widest adoption gaps?

- ☐ Front-line workers due to limited access to tools and technology
- ☐ Mid-level managers who see AI as threatening their coordinating role
- ☐ Senior executives who lack hands-on familiarity
- ☐ Tenured employees in specialized functions who don't see relevance to their work
- ☐ Other (please specify)

38. How are you preparing for the talent market shift as AI proficiency becomes essential?

- ☐ We've adjusted hiring criteria to emphasize AI literacy and adaptability
- ☐ We're offering premium compensation for roles requiring advanced AI skills
- ☐ We're focusing on building an "AI-forward" employer brand and showcasing how employees can do high-impact work using AI
- ☐ We're creating retention programs specifically for high-AI-proficiency employees
- ☐ Other (please specify)

39. What approach are you taking to reskill employees whose jobs are at risk of being eliminated or significantly reduced due to AI?

- ☐ We're offering voluntary reskilling programs
- ☐ We've conducted a skills gap analysis and are providing targeted training pathways to adjacent roles within the company
- ☐ We're being transparent about at-risk roles and offering comprehensive reskilling with guaranteed placement in new positions for successful participants

- ☐ We're taking a gradual transition approach—redeploying affected employees to higher-value tasks while their routine work shifts to AI
- ☐ We're primarily managing this through attrition and selective hiring freezes rather than proactive reskilling
- ☐ Other (please specify)

40. How concerned are you that AI will result in considerable job displacement across the economy in the next three years?

- ☐ Not at all concerned
- ☐ Moderately concerned
- ☐ Very Concerned

41. Which external factors do you see as having the biggest impacts on your company's performance in 2026? (Please select two)

- ☐ Economic uncertainty due to inflation
- ☐ Impact of additional tariffs
- ☐ Legal/regulatory uncertainty

- ☐ Geopolitical instability
- ☐ Reduced regulations
- ☐ Increased consumer spending
- ☐ Productivity gains from AI
- ☐ Other (please specify)

42. What have been some successes in implementing AI in your HR function?

43. How is AI changing your HR Operating Model?

44. What are the challenges in implementing AI in your HR function?

ELT Dynamics

45. Please describe the extent to which you agree with the following statements about the Executive Leadership Team (ELT).

	Strongly disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Slightly agree	Strongly agree
The ELT engages in healthy debate.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Our ELT gives serious consideration to everyone's ideas for how to do things better.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The ELT considers all members input when problem-solving.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Slightly agree	Strongly agree
ELT members engage in productive debates in an effort to improve decision making.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members reveal their true selves without being threatened.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The ELT ensures conflicts are resolved effectively.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The ELT values its members people, not just their role as executives.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members share and learn about one another as people.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members appreciate the differences other members bring to the company.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members work together to define a strategy for the company	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members reach and execute decisions (“disagree and commit”)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Slightly agree	Strongly agree
ELT members hold each other accountable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members prioritize an enterprise rather than business unit/functional perspective	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members recognize the collective ownership of top talent/leadership pipeline	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members trust one another	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ELT members are viewed by each other as having credibility	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Overall, this is a high-functioning ELT.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

CHRO Isolation

46. We have often heard the CHRO role is a lonely job. We are looking to explore more about this. The following statements describe how people sometimes feel. For each statement, please indicate how often you feel the way described.

	Strongly Disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Slightly agree	Strongly agree
I think the CHRO job is a naturally isolating job.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I lack people in which I can confide at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
There is no one I can turn to at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel left out at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My relationships with others at work are more work-related than personal.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel isolated from others in the HR function.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have strong professional relationships with the Executive Leadership Team.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly Disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Slightly agree	Strongly agree
I sympathize with others' feelings.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am not interested in other people's problems.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I socialize with others in the ELT outside of work	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am unhappy being unable to share what is happening at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Others confide in me more than I can confide in others at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I'm not lacking people around me, I lack connection to people around me.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I talk to a lot of different people at parties.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I keep in the background.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I socialize with other members of the HR function outside of work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Strongly
Disagree

Slightly disagree

Neither agree
nor disagree

Slightly agree

Strongly agree

I have strong personal
relationships with the HR
Leadership Team.

☐☐☐☐☐

47. Please describe the extent to which you agree with the following
statements:

Strongly
Disagree

Slightly disagree

Neither agree
nor disagree

Slightly agree

Strongly agree

In the HR profession, I feel
socially connected to others.

☐☐☐☐☐

In the organization, I feel
socially connected to others.

☐☐☐☐☐

In the HR function, I feel
socially connected to others.

☐☐☐☐☐

In the C-suite, I feel socially
connected to others.

☐☐☐☐☐

48. To what extent do you agree with the following statement: *"I often feel isolated or lonely in my role as CHRO"*?

- ☐ Strongly agree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Strongly disagree

49. If you do experience feelings of professional loneliness or disconnection, what are the primary contributing factors? *(Select all that apply)*

- ☐ Limited peer relationships at the executive level
- ☐ Confidential nature of HR work restricts open dialogue
- ☐ Lack of understanding from other executives about HR challenges
- ☐ Geographic distance from team or leadership
- ☐ Lack of engagement with CHRO networks or communities
- ☐ Difficulty finding mentors who understand the role
- ☐ Other (please specify)

50. Which of the following do you do to maintain professional connections and combat isolation? (*Select all that apply*)

- ☐ Participate in external CHRO peer networks or roundtables
- ☐ Regular one-on-one meetings with trusted executive peers
- ☐ Engage with an executive coach or mentor
- ☐ Attend industry conferences and networking events
- ☐ Participate in online communities for HR leaders
- ☐ Maintain relationships with CHROs at other organizations
- ☐ Schedule informal interactions with colleagues beyond formal meetings
- ☐ Other (please specify)

51. What would be most valuable in helping you feel more connected and supported in your CHRO role? Please select your **TOP THREE**.

- ☐ More structured peer networking opportunities with other CHROs
- ☐ A formal mentorship or advisory program
- ☐ Better integration and collaboration with C-suite peers
- ☐ Access to confidential forums for discussing sensitive challenges
- ☐ More recognition of the strategic value of the CHRO role

- ☐ Regular external coaching or leadership development
- ☐ Increased board-level interaction and visibility
- ☐ Internal HR leadership team development and connection

Leadership Style and Competence

52. To what extent would you describe your CEO as being skilled in the following...

	Strongly Disagree	Slightly Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Slightly Agree	Strongly Agree
Making it legitimate to contribute opinions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Employing participative decision making.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Maintaining an open climate for discussion.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Encouraging career development.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly Disagree	Slightly Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Slightly Agree	Strongly Agree
Seeing that everyone has a development plan.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Coaching people on career issues.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Being aware of when people are burning out.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Encouraging people to have work/life balance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Recognizing feelings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Identifying the changing needs of the customer.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Starting ambitious programs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Getting unit members to exceed traditional performance patterns.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Insuring that company policies are known.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Emphasizing accuracy in work efforts.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Providing tight project management.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly Disagree	Slightly Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Slightly Agree	Strongly Agree
Developing a competitive focus.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Modeling an intense work effort.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Producing faster unit outcomes.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Being open to change	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Building an aligned and connected direct team	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

53. As Artificial Intelligence (AI) becomes increasingly prevalent in organizations, it is reshaping the nature of work, jobs, and required competencies. Considering this shift, please indicate the extent to which you believe each of the following **leadership competencies** will become more or less important for **leaders at all levels** (not just CEOs) to be effective in the future.

Extremely
Less
Important

Much Less

Somewhat
Less

Stay the
Same

Somewhat
More

Much More

Extremely
More
Important

Collaboration and

Inclusivity: Promoting teamwork, valuing diversity, and ensuring inclusivity.



○

CCC

Communication and

Transparency: Open, clear, and honest communication builds trust and strengthens team relationships, ensuring alignment and clarity.



○

CCC

Accountability and Ethical

Leadership: Holding oneself and others accountable while fostering an environment of integrity within the team.



○

CCC

Strategic Thinking and Visionary Leadership:

Setting long-term strategies, anticipating trends, and driving innovation to shape the organization's future.



○

CCC

Extremely
Less
Important

Much Less

Somewhat
Less

Stay the
Same

Somewhat
More

Much More

Extremely
More
Important

Innovation and Change

Management: Managing change, encouraging innovation, and remaining agile to ensure the organization stays competitive.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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Customer Focus and

Result Orientation: Prioritize customer needs and align their team's work with the organization's goals to achieve sustainable results.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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Digital and Technological

Dexterity: Leveraging digital tools and technological innovation to improve organizational processes and decision-making.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
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